



DIY PC Monitor

This fun little Raspberry Pi based modification gives you a realtime dashboard of your PC's vital statistics. <https://dgit.in/may20-93>



D-Wave computers for research

D-Wave has opened up its hybrid quantum cloud service to researchers working with the novel coronavirus. <https://dgit.in/may20-94>

only indicate what a single core on the entire processor is capable of hitting. The remaining cores are all running at much lower frequencies. Modern processors have to balance performance with power consumption and running some cores at higher frequencies while other cores lag significantly behind is the mechanism used to attain this balance. Without this your processor would end up being hotter than the core of the sun. Over the last year, we have seen certain processors capable of

hitting the specified boost frequencies across all cores, however, the time for which they remain boosted is never mentioned. That's because it's quite low.

So what does this all mean for the typical gamer? Get any damn processor with eight cores. That's about it. Both AMD and Intel are very good at running games on their processors. Intel has had a slight advantage in this domain until the 9th Gen Core processors but we don't know if Intel will retain that when their 10th Gen

processors roll out early this month. The only reason you'd want more cores is if you are multi-tasking i.e. want to game and stream at the same time. Even in this usage scenario, your livestream codecs eat up a lot of your CPU so even with 12 and 16 cores, you need to figure out what quality you wish to maintain for your stream. If 720p is all you need then a single processor is more than enough. If you want to stream 4K/60FPS, then consider getting a second rig with a capture card for best results. 

BUYING ADVICE

LAPTOP WITH MONITOR SUPPORT

Q Hi, I have been reading Digit for around two years now. I have seen many builds and configs, I plan on buying an ASUS Zephyrus G14 as it has a great processor and a decent GPU. I want to use this primarily for gaming on the go. I plan on using an external keyboard and monitor. I want to connect a large monitor, something like the Alienware 27-inch AW2720HF. I want to know if it is compatible as an external monitor. Could you please tell me how to connect an external monitor to a 14-inch laptop like the Zephyrus G14? Please help me in my query.

—Abhay Rao



ASUS Zephyrus G14

A Hey Abhay, Most laptops have a display output that can be used to connect external displays to the laptop. In the

case of the Zephyrus G14, it has an HDMI 2.0b and a USB Type-C port capable of linking displays. And the monitor in question, the Alienware 27-inch AW2720HF has HDMI as well as DisplayPorts for display input. It has a lot of USB Type-A ports but they aren't capable of linking displays. So you should be able to use the monitor with your laptop. Ensure you get a proper cable that says "HDMI High Speed" as these are rated to run at 18 Gbps. High Speed HDMI cables are quite common in the market and do not cost a lot. Certain companies do make ridiculous claims to sell these cables at a premium price, don't fall for those claims. A 6-ft High Speed HDMI cable usually sells for less than INR 400.

WI-FI 6 ROUTER

Q Hi Agent001, I would like to know which is the best value for money Wi-Fi 6 router, in your opinion?

Moreover, if your ISP is giving you a 10 Mbps plan, will using a Wi-Fi 6 router really help or it is just a marketing gimmick??

—Ravikant Joshi

A Hey Ravikant, Since Wi-Fi 6 consumer products are new in the market, they sell at a slight premium right now. The TP-Link AX10 1500 Wi-Fi 6 Router is a pretty decent unit if you're looking

for a budget router. Just having a Wi-Fi 6 standard router helps with better performance in dense environments. If you're in an urban setting, this will increasingly become a valuable factor for considering Wi-Fi 6. Moreover, Wi-Fi also has OFDMA support which enables high bandwidth for each



TP-Link AX10 1500 Wi-Fi 6 router

connected client. However, OFDMA is not enabled by default for all bands in all routers. We are not certain about the TP-Link AX10 either since the website only says it has OFDMA but does not specify which bands have it. Needless to say, it's still a good router. Coming to your question about using a Wi-Fi router with a low bandwidth line. Obviously, you are not going to get more than 10 Mbps on your internet line. Some services have peering, such as YouTube so you might get better speeds with such services but the router doesn't have anything to do with that. It's when you look at transfer speeds between devices within your home network that you will see huge speeds thanks to Wi-Fi 6. 